Response to the Academic Editor

Manuscript: *Proxy-Based Diagnostics of Quantum Oracle Sketching Robustness for Non-IID Sensor and Telemetry Streams*
Journal: *Sensors* (MDPI) · **Manuscript ID:** sensors-4470240

Editor's comment. *"I strongly invite the Authors to not include preprints among references. These works are still undergoing the peer-review process, thus meaning that their content may change prior to publication (if they will be finally published). The Authors can substitute them with related works already published."*

Response. We thank the Academic Editor and agree with the principle. We audited all 54 references: every entry was checked against the publisher's own metadata, and all 51 DOIs resolved and matched the cited title, first author, venue, and year. The audit found two preprints. One had in fact been published and has been replaced: the Kallaugher, Parekh and Voronova paper now carries its published version (SOSA 2025, pp. 9–45, DOI 10.1137/1.9781611978315.2). The same sweep also fixed a transposed article number in the Su, Guo and Wang (2024) entry, which now reads *Information Sciences* **676**, article 120799, DOI 10.1016/j.ins.2024.120799.

One preprint remains: Zhao et al., "Exponential quantum advantage in processing massive classical data" (arXiv:2604.07639). On 16 August 2026 we re-checked whether it has been published or accepted anywhere. It has not: the arXiv record is still at version 1 with no journal reference; Crossref, Semantic Scholar, dblp, INSPIRE-HEP, Google Scholar and OpenReview list it as arXiv-only; it appears in no 2026 accepted-paper list (FOCS, STOC, QIP, TQC, CCC, SODA) and on no publisher page; and the authors' publication pages give only the arXiv posting. We retain it because it is not cited as evidentiary support for a claim of ours; it is the specific framework under study. The paper examines how that framework's correlation assumptions behave on non-IID streams; citing a related published work in its place would attribute its theorems to authors who did not prove them, and removing it would leave the framework the paper analyses unattributed.

We have, however, reduced the manuscript's reliance on it to the minimum honest attribution permits. Its in-text citations were cut from eight to six by consolidating two repeats. The entry is labelled "Preprint", and a footnote at its first citation states this status and explains why the preprint is not used as evidentiary support for the paper's empirical conclusions: no quantum algorithm is implemented or simulated, and every inherited quantity is listed with its provenance and epistemic status in Table 1. We also added the strongest published anchor of its kind — Kallaugher, Parekh and Voronova (STOC 2024, pp. 1805–1815, DOI 10.1145/3618260.3649709), the first exponential quantum–classical space separation for a natural streaming problem — co-cited with it in the Related Work and in the footnote; in doing so we corrected a Related Work sentence that had credited the 2021 FOCS paper with an exponential separation (its advantage is polynomial). The bibliography now has 55 entries, and we re-checked that every in-text citation matches exactly one entry.

Should the work appear in a peer-reviewed venue before this manuscript reaches proofs, we will substitute the published version at that stage; and if the Editor still prefers a different remedy, we will follow the Editor's guidance.

On behalf of all authors,

AbdelMoniem Helmy (corresponding author) abdelmoniem.hafez@cu.edu.eg · ORCID 0000-0001-5996-6019